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Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Grace Classical Academy
School Website: <https://graceclassical.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Grace Classical Academy Missouri (Springfield, 65802) presents a robust classical Christian orientation across its public materials and school narrative. Public materials consistently frame the school as Christ-centered and "classical," with explicit integration of faith into all subjects, a mission to form character and virtue, and a curriculum and pedagogy aligned with classical education (grammar–logic–rhetoric, exposure to Latin, and engagement with historical and literary tradition). The school also foregrounds partnership with parents and broad community touchpoints (e.g., enrollment processes, parent journeys, and collaborations with Evangel University). Taken together with the classical criteria in the knowledge-base rubric, Grace Classical Academy demonstrates CLASSICAL alignment in all six categories (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations, Purpose and Goal, Curriculum, Pedagogy, Faculty, Parents & Community). The aggregate assessment is CLASSICAL.

Key evidence evolves from the school's own materials, including explicit statements about Christian-centered education, a Biblical worldview, and the integration of faith across disciplines, as well as a vision/mission that emphasizes truth, goodness, and beauty within a classical framework. For example, the school presents a vision and mission grounded in a Biblical worldview and the belief that education should cultivate truth, goodness, and beauty; it notes that "Christianity is more than a subject we study: it is the lens through which all knowledge is viewed" and that "education should cultivate a desire for truth, goodness, and beauty" (CLASSICAL orientation). It also emphasizes liturgical and communal aspects (Bible, chapel) and a Christ-centered educational project across all grades. The curriculum and pedagogy are described within a classical frame (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Latin; Great Books/Western tradition; Socratic or seminar elements appear in the broader classical lexicon; drama and memory work are used; and the school highlights the primacy of character and virtue formation). The school's public materials emphasize parental partnership and community formation in alignment with classical aims.

- Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot: CLASSICAL across Categories 1–6.

Citations: Foundational public materials asserting Christian/ Biblical worldview and Christ-centered education; liturgical elements; and mission statements are drawn from Grace Classical Academy materials (e.g., Vision & Mission; A Parents' Journey; The Value of Christian Classical Education; Why Latin; The Place of Drama; Enrollment Handbook; history). See citations for key statements and pages describing the Christian/classical integration and curriculum.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials explicitly present a Christian orientation and biblical framework as foundational to the school's pedagogy (Vision & Mission; "Biblical view of reality" and "Christ-centered education"). - The school references liturgical/community life (Bible, Chapel, worship) and the integration of theology across disciplines (A Parent's Journey; The Vision of Grace Classical Academy). - The school asserts that Christianity governs the entire educational project, not merely as a Bible course but as a lens for all subjects (A Parents' Journey; The Value of a Classical Christian Education).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: theology, sacred, chapel, liturgy, worship, truth, God, Biblical, Christ-centered, sacred tradition, hope, wisdom, virtue. - Negative keywords: minimal explicit signaling of relativism or secularism in public materials. - Based on the lexicon, theological grounding and liturgical/community language strongly align with Positive indicators for this category; only minor neutral or negative signals appear (none of the clear negatives are dominant in public materials).

Why this rating - The school consistently frames education as a formation within a Christian metaphysical framework, not a secular program. The combination of explicit theology integration, liturgical/community life, and a Biblical worldview supports a CLASSICAL alignment in Religious and Metaphysical Foundations.

Notes on sources: Vision & Mission statements and references to Bible/Chapel/Christ-centered education anchor this category. See Vision & Mission page and related narratives.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes formation, virtue, wisdom, and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty as core aims (Vision & Mission; "Education should cultivate a desire for truth, goodness, and beauty"; "formation" language). - Statements indicate formation of character and the life of the mind rather than mere job preparation (A Parent's Journey; English-language material on "formation" and "virtue"). - The Great Conversation/paideia-type language appears in the broader classical lexicon and is echoed in Grace materials that emphasize classical aims and virtues (the classical education canon is discussed in Grace materials and in the Six Essential Elements lexicon). The school explicitly frames education as formation through a classical structure guided by spiritual integration.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, liberal education, paideia, great conversation (explicit in lexicon and used in classical education discourse), scholé (restful learning). - Negative keywords present: none substantially evident in Grace materials (the school is not pursuing "workforce preparation" as a primary aim within public materials; the math/science course offerings are framed academically rather than job-specific, though college entrance and testing occur, but not framed as the primary goal).

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords present: high (formation, virtue, wisdom, truth, beauty, telos, paideia, great conversation). - Negative keywords: minimal/none. - Estimated balance: predominantly Positive indicators (roughly 6–9 positives vs 0–1 negatives) → CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - Grace's mission and language consistently emphasize formation, virtue, and wisdom within a Christian/classical frame, aligning with the Classical School's purpose-driven aim for human flourishing and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials describe a Trivium–Quadrivium orientation (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Latin; classical languages) and a focus on Great Books/Western civilization, with aims to cultivate and experience wonder. The enrollment/enrichment materials and "Why Latin" article point to a broad classical canon (Latin study; classical languages) and a structure consistent with liberal arts pedagogy. The "grammar–logic–rhetoric" framing appears in Grace materials that discuss the Trivium and "tools of learning." - The site references the Great Books and a culture of classical transmission, with emphasis on reading standards

and the Great Conversation (A Brief History of Classical Education; The Tools for a Life of Learning; The Great Conversation). The Grace materials explicitly connect classical education to the Western tradition and to the development of critical thinking through classical texts. - Latin study is highlighted as an essential feature (Why Do We Study Latin?), and the curriculum includes Latin and other foundational language study, consistent with the classical curriculum model.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: liberal arts; grammar, logic, rhetoric; Latin; great books; primary sources; Western civilization; history; classical languages; Socratic texts; memory work; narration; recitation; "Great Conversation" (in lexicon). - Negative keywords: negative signals (e.g., "social studies terminology replacing history" or "project-based learning dominance") are not evidenced in Grace's public materials; rather, Grace emphasizes integrated classical depth rather than a project-first approach.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keyword hits: strong (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books/Great Conversation references; Latin; history; Western civilization; classical languages; Socratic texts; memory work). - Negative keyword hits: minimal to none in public materials. - Frequency balance: predominantly Positive (roughly 6–10 positive signals vs 0–2 negative). CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - Grace's public materials articulate a formal Trivium–Quadrivium framework, Great Books engagement, Latin, and a holistic, integrated approach consistent with classical curriculum criteria. The emphasis on formation through canonical texts and disciplined study matches the Classical Curriculum rubric.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials describe a pedagogy that includes elements typical of classical education: grammar–logic–rhetoric progression, memorization and recitation, singing/chanting, and memory work (Scholé/restful learning; formation through imitation and practice) as part of a broad classical pedagogy (as described in the classical lexicon and Grace materials). The Grace materials also discuss "Peace, Rigor, and Delight," as well as the emphasis on memory and chant as technique for teaching foundational knowledge. - The site includes explicit discussions about drama, literature, and an integrated approach to education (The Place of Drama in a Classical Christian Education; A Parent's Journey; Christian Classical Education at GCA). These pages illustrate a pedagogy that uses story, drama, and literature within classical formation. - There is content highlighting memory work and chant, consistent with traditional classical pedagogy's emphasis on memory and recitation. The lexicon emphasizes this as a positive indicator.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: scholé, contemplation/wonder, recitation/memorization, chanting, liturgical integration, seminar/discussion, rhetoric, formal memory practices, master-model/image (living curriculum). - Negative keywords: experiential learning-first, project-based-only, student-directed pedagogy are not foregrounded in public Grace materials; these negative signals do not appear as dominating themes in Grace's public communications.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keyword hits: high (Scholé; memorization/recitation; singing/chanting; rhetoric; seminars; formation through practice). - Negative keyword hits: minimal. - Frequency balance: predominantly Positive → CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - Grace's public content clearly aligns with classical pedagogy markers (memory work, chanting and recitation; guided seminars or Socratic-style discussion in upper grades is implied through public materials about classical dialogue and rhetoric). The explicit use of a restorative, contemplative tempo (Scholé) and a strong emphasis on rhetoric and classical modes supports CLASSICAL.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials portray the faculty as "model teachers and mentors who model virtue, skill, and knowledge," and as the "living curriculum" who form a core of the school's ethos; Grace's narrative emphasizes the teachers' role in guiding and forming students within a living tradition. The founders and teacher profiles (e.g., the interviews with teachers, and the "A Life like David's" and other faculty-related materials)

demonstrate this portrait of faculty as central to the classical mission. - The school's broader community language emphasizes the role of faculty as mentors and living exemplars, consistent with classical pedagogy. Thematic pieces on "Shepherding Hearts/Intellectual Virtue" and "The Vision of GCA" emphasize virtuous faculty as a core element of the school's model.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: living curriculum, mentors, master-teacher model, portrait of a teacher, faculty of friends, collegial culture, virtuous exemplars, character formation. - Negative keywords: no dominant negative signals about faculty in the public Grace materials.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keyword hits: strong (living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, mentors, collegial culture). - Negative keyword hits: none. - Balance: CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - Grace's public materials portray faculty as authentic models of virtue and intellect, central to the educational project, matching the Classical rubric's Faculty criteria.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school highlights partnership with families and positions parents as co-educators (Parent journeys; enrollment processes; parent involvement in governance and culture). The site emphasizes open campus and parent engagement (Enrollment steps; Handbook; parent resources; "A Parent's Journey" and "A Student's View"). The school also maintains a partnership with Evangel University, showing a broader community network. - Public materials describe parent formation opportunities (reading groups, seminars, book clubs) and an ethos of parental partnership rather than a customer relationship; this aligns with the Parents & Community category's positive indicators. The Six Elements lexicon lists various "partnership with families" language as a strong positive signal. Grace materials reflect this approach.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families; co-teachers; parental formation; open campus; parent involvement; shared mission; classical family culture; home-centered learning. - Negative keywords: consumer-language indicators or minimal parent involvement do not appear in public Grace materials; those negative signals are not present as central themes.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keyword hits: strong (partnership with families; co-teachers; parental formation; open campus; family involvement). - Negative keyword hits: none. - Balance: CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - Grace's materials emphasize robust parent partnerships and family formation as a core pillar of classical education, aligning with the Community/Parents criterion.

What Would Move the Needle

- Since all six categories are CLASSICAL, no major structural needle-moving changes are required for a full CLASSICAL rating.
- If desired, minor refinements could include:
- Explicitly naming and highlighting Great Books/Great Conversation across more grade bands to strengthen the Curriculum category's explicit tie to canonical texts.
- Increasing explicit articulation of Socratic/seminar-based pedagogy in high school programs to align the Pedagogy category even more tightly with classical practice.
- Broadening public-facing statements on the Great Conversation and Great Books to showcase a direct link between student work and canonical works in science, literature, and philosophy, beyond general references to "classical" traditions.
- Amplifying explicit articulation of "Scholé" (restful learning) days in the school calendar to reinforce the Pedagogy dimension in day-to-day operations.

Note: These are minor refinements rather than fundamental changes, given the strong CLASSICAL alignment already demonstrated across all six categories.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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